



The Ultimate Virtualisation Face-off Between

Qemu, VirtualBox, VMware Player and Parallels Workstation

In this article, we take a look at four of the most well known and commonly used virtualisation software for Linux.

When it comes to virtualisation, Linux unarguably has more prowess and offers better performance as the host OS than most other operating systems. Mac does indeed allow you to run MS Windows in a virtualised environment, but it is only Linux that offers all-encompassing support for most popular operating systems.

And talking about virtualisation products for Linux devices, the options are plenty. However, in this article, we will focus on four major options—Qemu, VirtualBox, VMware Player and Parallels Workstation. Before comparing these, let's first look at each of them in isolation.

Qemu

Qemu can be used both as a machine emulator and as virtualisation software. It lets you run Windows programs

on your Linux machine, as well as execute guest code directly on host devices. And the best part is that Qemu is open source software.

VirtualBox

Oracle VM VirtualBox, or just VirtualBox as it is popularly called, is full-blown virtualisation software typically meant for the x86 architecture. Even though Oracle primarily projects it as a product for enterprise use, VirtualBox can and does suffice for general computing enthusiasts who would like to try their hands at virtualisation. In fact, VirtualBox is so neatly laid out and simple in operation that it should be your first pick if you aren't already familiar with virtualisation. It supports numerous operating systems apart from Linux and Windows, including the